3 p.m. dumplings

Pork, beef and tofu or mushroom duxelles filling, boiled or deep-fried

Makes 50 to 60 dumplings per filling · **Prep** 1 h · **Cook** 20 min · Adapted from masterclass.com

Roy Choi's dumplings, with a choice of two fillings that share one seasoning base. Cook the mushrooms until their moisture is gone and let them cool before mixing, or the filling turns wet and the wrappers tear.

INGREDIENTS

Seasoning base (for one filling)

- 120 ml (½ cup) napa cabbage or green cabbage, finely chopped
- 1 bunch scallions, thinly sliced, plus more for garnish
- 2 tbsp ginger, minced (from a 5 cm (2 inch) knob)
- 2 tbsp garlic, minced
- 1 tsp gochugaru (Korean chili flakes)
- 1 tbsp toasted sesame seeds, crushed
- 2 tbsp oyster sauce
- 2 tsp toasted sesame oil
- 1 tbsp soy sauce
- 1 tbsp unseasoned rice vinegar
- 1 egg

Meat filling

- 115 g (4 oz) ground pork
- 115 g (4 oz) ground beef
- 115 g (4 oz) firm tofu, finely crumbled

Mushroom filling (veggie duxelles)

- 225 g (8 oz) button mushrooms
- 140 g (5 oz) shiitake mushrooms
- 60 ml (¼ cup) neutral oil (canola, grapeseed, vegetable)
- 1 large shallot (about 85 g / 3 oz), finely chopped
- 120 ml (½ cup) dry white wine
- 2 tbsp chives, thinly sliced

For wrapping

- 125 g (1 cup) plain flour, for dusting
- 50 to 60 round dumpling wrappers, about 8 cm (3 inches) wide
- 1 beaten egg or a small dish of water

For cooking and serving

- 5 to 8 cm (2 to 3 inches) neutral oil in the pot, if frying
- Kosher salt or coarse sea salt, to taste
- Freshly ground black pepper, to taste
- Scallion dipping sauce (optional), to serve
- Chili oil (optional), to serve

METHOD

1. **Make the sauce.** If serving it, make the scallion dipping sauce first and set it aside.
2. **Meat filling: mix.** In a medium bowl, combine the seasoning base with the pork, beef and tofu. Season with salt and pepper and mix until even.
3. **Mushroom filling: chop.** Pulse the button and shiitake mushrooms in a food processor until finely chopped, or chop them finely by hand. A blender jar is too narrow to chop them evenly.
4. **Mushroom filling: cook.** Heat the oil in a medium skillet over medium heat until shimmering. Cook the shallot, stirring, for under a minute, until fragrant and translucent. Add the mushrooms and cook 2 to 3 minutes more, stirring, until most of their moisture has cooked out and the edges are lightly browned.
5. **Mushroom filling: deglaze.** Add the wine and scrape up the browned bits. Season with salt and pepper. Once the mushrooms have absorbed the wine, toss in the chives and take the pan off the heat. Let it cool to room temperature.
6. **Mushroom filling: mix.** In a medium bowl, combine the seasoning base and season with salt and pepper. Add the cooled mushrooms and mix until even.
7. **Fill the wrappers.** Dust a clean work surface with flour and lay the wrappers out in a single layer. Spoon a heaping teaspoon (about ½ tablespoon) of filling into the centre of each, then dab the edges with egg wash or water.
8. **Seal them.** Use one of three folds, keeping the filling in the centre: - Half-fold: fold in half like a taco, press out any air, and pinch the edges shut. - Crimp: pinch the top together; holding it, fold one side back over itself into a pleat, repeat on the other side, and pinch the remaining edges shut. - Beggar's purse: gather the edges above the filling and squeeze just below them like a drawstring bag, then twist gently to seal the top. Half-folds suit boiling; crimps and purses suit frying. There's no firm rule, so experiment.
9. **Hold or freeze.** If not cooking straight away, cover with a damp towel or plastic wrap so the wrappers don't dry out.
10. **To boil.** Fill a large pot about ⅔ full of water, salt it generously and bring to a boil, then lower to a simmer. Cook the dumplings in batches of about 10, without stirring, until they float and the skins turn translucent and tighten around the filling, 3 to 5 minutes. Lift them out with a spider or slotted spoon and drain well.
11. **To fry.** Heat 5 to 8 cm of oil in a large pot over medium-high heat, leaving a few centimetres of headroom. It's ready when a chopstick tip dipped in it gives a steady stream of bubbles. Fry in batches of 4 or 5 without crowding, 2 to 3 minutes, turning halfway, until crisp and just golden; they darken a little after. Drain on a paper towel–lined plate.
12. **Serve.** Plate the dumplings, drizzle with the dipping sauce and chili oil to taste, top with sliced scallions, and eat straight away.

NOTES

- Making both fillings? Double the seasoning base: each filling takes one full batch.
- The uncooked dumplings keep for several months in the freezer.